

Industry News

Mobile number portability by September

Come September, cellphone users in some parts of India, including the four metros Delhi, Mumbai, Kolkata and Chennai, will be able to switch operators even while retaining their existing number.

The Department of Telecom (DoT) has issued a notification in this regard saying "Mobile number portability (MNP) is to be implemented in Delhi, Mumbai, Maharashtra and Gujarat service areas of Zone I and Kolkata, Tamil Nadu, Chennai, Andhra and Karnataka of Zone 2 within six months of award of licence by 20th September this year and in the rest of the country by March 20, 2010."

MNP Interconnection Telecom Solutions has been awarded a ten-year licence for eleven telecom circles in the South and the East India.

India dumps \$10 laptop, orders 250,000 OLPCs

The government of India has signed an agreement with the One Laptop Per Child (OLPC) Foundation to purchase 250,000 OLPC XO laptops from the foundation for distribution across the country. The move would come as a surprise to many in the industry given the country's past disparagement of the programme. However, the struggling OLPC organisation will certainly get a much-needed financial boost from this contract.

Last year, the entire tech world eagerly waited for the launch of the \$10 laptop designed by students of Vellore Institute of Technology, scientists in Indian Institute of Science, Bangalore, IIT-Madras, UGC and MHRD, but it turned out to be a failure. The \$10 laptop 'prototype' with 2GB RAM wasn't a laptop at all but a computing device along with a hard

Sarma becomes new TRAI chairman

Dr J.S. Sarma has been appointed as the new chairman of the Telecom Regulatory Authority of India (TRAI). He succeeds former TRAI chairman Nripendra Mishra, who retired on March 22, 2009.

Sarma, who was earlier the member of the TDSAT, is a 1971-batch IAS officer of Andhra Pradesh cadre. He has a lot of exposure in the telecom sector. He was the Department of Telecommunications secretary and the Telecom Commission chairman from June 2005 to July 2006.

Datt takes over as CMD, BEL

Bharat Electronics Limited (BEL) has appointed Ashwani Kumar Datt, 57, as chairman and managing director. Datt succeeds V.V.R. Sastry, who retired on superannuation on April 30, 2009.

Datt was director (other units) of BEL before his elevation as CMD. As director (other units), he headed eight of the nine units of BEL located at Ghaziabad, Panchkula, Navi Mumbai, Koldwara, Pune, Hyderabad, Chennai and Machilipatnam.

Raman to spearhead TVS Electronics

S.S. Raman, director, TVS Electronics, has been promoted to the position of whole-time director and CEO, TVS-Electronics, and managing director for the recently formed TVS-E Servicetec.

Commenting on the appointment, Gopal Srinivasan, chairman, TVS-Electronics and TVS-E Servicetec, said, "In view of the strong synergy between the businesses of TVS Electronics and TVS E Servicetec, and given Raman's

dedicated expertise in the field of information technology, we are confident that his role will drive the goal of the organisations and add greater value to both the businesses."

disk with e-books, e-journals and relevant educative material through the Sakshat portal. Post this episode, India might have realised that it is not possible to make a laptop at that cost and chose to embrace OLPC instead. OLPC's XO laptops will be purchased for the stu-

In Focus

dedicated expertise in the field of information technology, we are confident that his role will drive the goal of the organisations and add greater value to both the businesses."

Kato to head Epson India

Epson, a digital imaging and printing solutions company, has appointed Eiji Kato as the new country head to spearhead its India operations. Kato replaces Etsuo Fujita, who moves back to Japan after six years in India.

Kato joined the Seiko-Epson Corporation in 1984, as a chemical engineer in the corporate research and development division. He has a bachelor's degree in ceramic materials from Nagoya Institute of Technology, Japan.

Tadanki takes helm at Yahoo! India

Yahoo! India has appointed Arun Tadanki as managing director with the mandate for expanding and consolidating business in sub-continental Asia, Middle East and Africa, filling a position lying vacant since August 2007. In this role, Tadanki will be based out of Delhi and report to Keith Nilsson, senior vice president, emerging markets.

Nakajima quits as NEC CEO

Toshio Nakajima is stepping down as president and CEO of NEC Electronics, effective June 25, 2009, amidst ongoing losses, sagging sales and a proposed merger with Renesas Technology Corp. Nakajima will become an advisor for NEC Electronics and will be replaced with Junshi Yamaguchi, executive vice president and member of the board.

dents across the country. Nearly 1500 Indian schools will get the latest batch of 250,000 OLPC XO laptops.

IIT-K to launch country's lightest nano satellite

India will get its lightest nano satellite called *Jugnu* by this December. The